Israelophobic antisemitism was also the ideological driving force behind the 2012 attack against the Jewish school in Toulouse and the 2014 attack on the Jewish Museum in Brussels. For both perpetrators, Mohammed Merah and Mehdi Nemmouche, killing Jews represented revenge for the supposed wrongdoings of the Jews in Israel against the Palestinians. According to Merah's statements (made when he was under siege by the police), the Jewish children in Toulouse were killed to "avenge" the deaths of Palestinian children killed by Israeli forces in Gaza and the West Bank.[25]

The growth of anti-Zionist antisemitism has gained momentum ever since Yasser Arafat re-elaborated the characteristics of traditional antisemitism into anti-Zionism. Moreover, by portraying the Palestinian cause as a question of justice and human rights, international pro-Palestinian activists endorsed the anti-Zionist discourse together with its antisemitic components. Therefore, under the abused façade of human rights, the fantasy grows that Israelis, like the Jews of the *Protocols of the Elders of Zion*, are congenital liars, Holocaust inventors, and bloodthirsty criminals like the Jews of the medieval blood libel. Israelis are abusers, colonialists, ethnic cleansers, apartheid promoters, and naturally violent. Israel poisons the Palestinian water supply, as Suha Arafat officially told a very surprised Hillary Clinton in Gaza back in 1999.[26]

In this repect, denial of the Holocaust and Jewish history also function to further Israelophobia. The Jews are said to lie about the Holocaust, which either never happened or is highly exaggerated, to justify their non-existent connection to Israel. Palestinian anti-Zionist discourse denies that Jews have lived throughout history in the Land of Israel, which, according to the Arabs, they cruelly conquered by destroying Palestine and establishing the "illegitimate" State of Israel.

It is therefore not possible to understand contemporary antisemitism if we do not see that it is rooted in these widespread opinions, which pervade European popular and political culture. Baroness Catherine Ashton, when condemning the 2012 Toulouse attack, compared the child victims of this antisemitic aggression to the Palestinian casualties from Israeli military strikes.[27] By comparing the Jewish victims of a willful terrorist attack directed against Jews to collateral victims of military self-defense strikes, she basically implied that Israelis consciously aim to kill Palestinian children. Such slanderous suggestions have become commonplace in Europe and undermine the security of Jews living there and elsewhere in the Diaspora.

It is symptomatic that in 2011, no less than 63 percent of Poles, 48 percent of Germans, and 38 percent of Italians were convinced that Israel is conducting a "war of extermination" against the Palestinians.[28] The European

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